

1-4 What Is Globalization?

Learning Objective 1-4

Identify three ways of understanding what globalization is.

Globalization ([The close integration of countries and peoples of the world.](#)) , generally speaking, is the close integration of countries and peoples of the world. This abstract five-syllable word is now frequently heard and debated. Those who approve of globalization count its contributions to include greater economic growth, higher standards of living, increased technology sharing, and more extensive cultural integration. Critics argue that globalization undermines wages in rich countries, exploits workers in poor countries, grants MNEs too much power, destroys the environment, and promotes inequality. So, what exactly is globalization? This section outlines three views on globalization, recommends the pendulum view, and introduces the idea of semiglobalization.